Motionholic

INDUSTRY RESEARCH REPORT · OCTOBER 2026

The Business Coach Industry Problems and Content Solutions

What business coaches are struggling with right now, and what to publish, produce and measure to fix it. 11 problems, 33 solutions.

Prepared by Motionholic · motionholic.com

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Executive summary

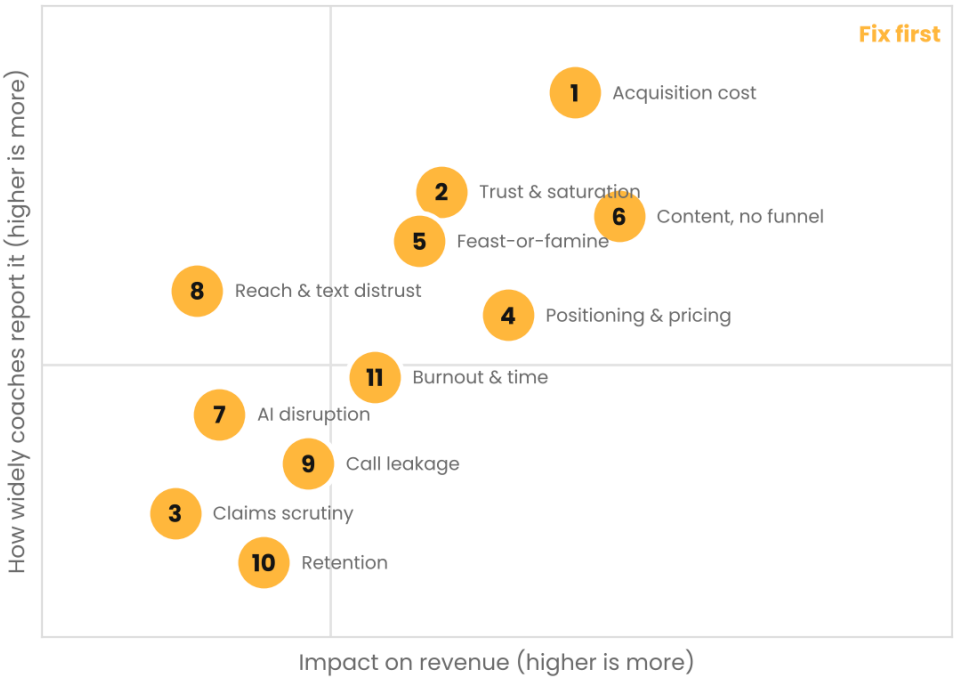
The coaching profession is bigger than ever and, for many practitioners, harder than ever. ICF's 2025 Global Coaching Study counts 122,974 coaches and $5.34 billion in revenue, but only 59% of coaches expect their income to grow, down from 73% in 2023. Our research across industry studies, regulator notices, practitioner research and B2B video benchmarks points to a common root: most business coaches are good at coaching and under-built at attracting, converting and keeping clients.

$5.34B
global coaching revenue, ICF 2025

122,974
practitioners worldwide, +54% since 2019

59%
expect income growth, down from 73%

This report ranks eleven problems and gives at least three content-led solutions for each. Content here means anything you publish, record or send to attract, educate and convince a buyer: short video, long-form video, email, case studies, calculators, scripts and community. The solutions are practical recommendations from this research, not guarantees of results.



Editorial assessment by the report author, based on the source mix; not a measured survey.

The 11 problems at a glance

#	Problem	One-line solution direction
01	Winning clients costs more, and gets harder every year	Proof-led content engine, repurposing, single-path lead magnet
02	Oversupply and a trust gap in the market	Case-study videos, teardown content, public scorecard
03	Regulators are watching earnings claims	Substantiation file, outcome stories, 'what to expect' explainer
04	Vague positioning and underpriced offers	Positioning series, offer video sales letter, value-math content
05	Feast-or-famine revenue and referral dependence	Always-on cadence, evergreen nurture, recurring product
06	Plenty of content, no conversion path	Funnel-mapped content, conversation starters, tighter booking path
07	AI is reshaping expectations, and the trust questions come with it	Human-first content, AI-use charter, original data moat
08	Organic reach is shrinking and written content is losing trust	Native short-form video, long-form trust assets, owned audience
09	Leaky discovery calls: no-shows and weak sales conversations	Pre-call sequence, objection clips, attribution tracking
10	Retention, accountability and churn	Onboarding content, between-session micro-content, referral loop
11	Burnout and time poverty	Batch recording, delegated post-production, repurposing

Industry snapshot

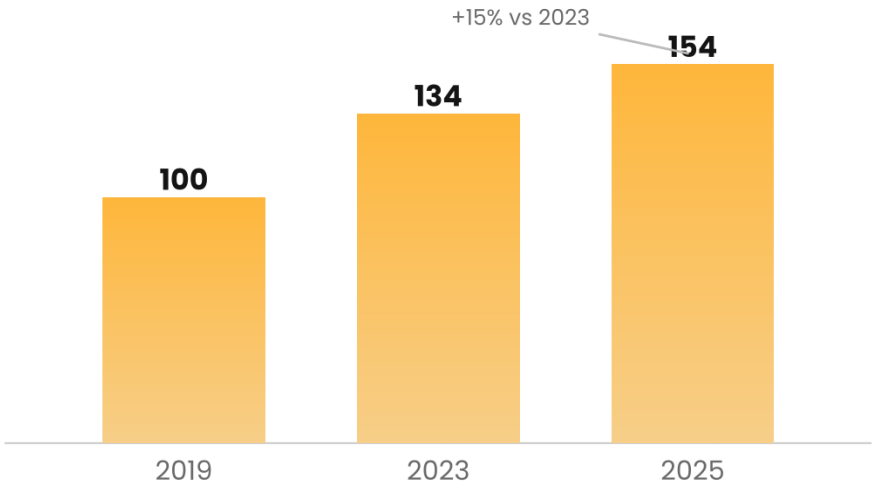
Demand for coaching is real, and the market keeps expanding. What has changed is competition, buyer scrutiny and the economics of getting found.

10,035
ICF 2025 survey responses from 127 countries

47%
coaches using digital coaching platforms

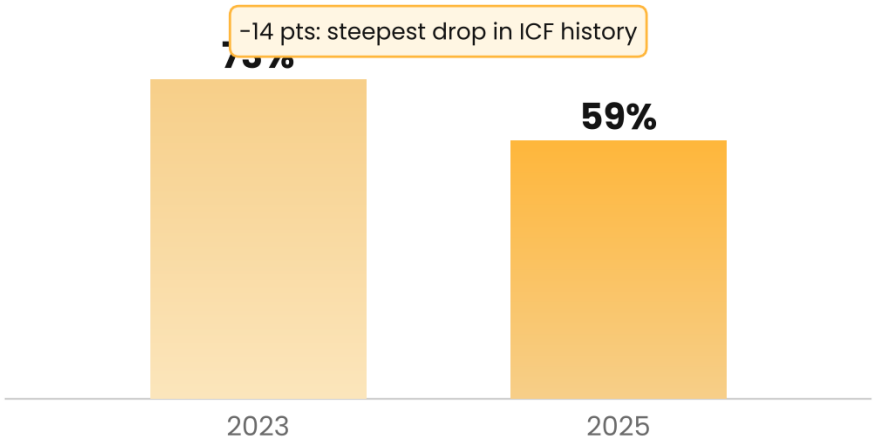
~65%
of coaches identify as business coaches (industry summary)

Practitioner count index (2019 = 100)



Derived from ICF Global Coaching Study 2025: 122,974 coaches, +15% vs 2023, +54% vs 2019.

Coaches who expect their income to rise



Source: ICF Global Coaching Studies 2023 and 2025, as analysed by The Coaching Tools Company.

KEY TAKEAWAY
The industry grew while confidence fell. Competition and buyer scepticism, not lack of demand, are the pressure points. That is why this report concentrates on trust, conversion and consistency.

01 Winning clients costs more, and gets harder every year

Client acquisition is the top complaint across practitioner blogs, benchmarks and coaching-business research.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Business coaches rarely struggle with coaching itself. They struggle to fill the calendar. One coaching-business analysis reports client acquisition costs up about 60% over six years, while ICF data shows most coaches earn modest incomes and growing numbers expect income to stall. Referrals carry many practices early on, then dry up, and paid ads get pricier.

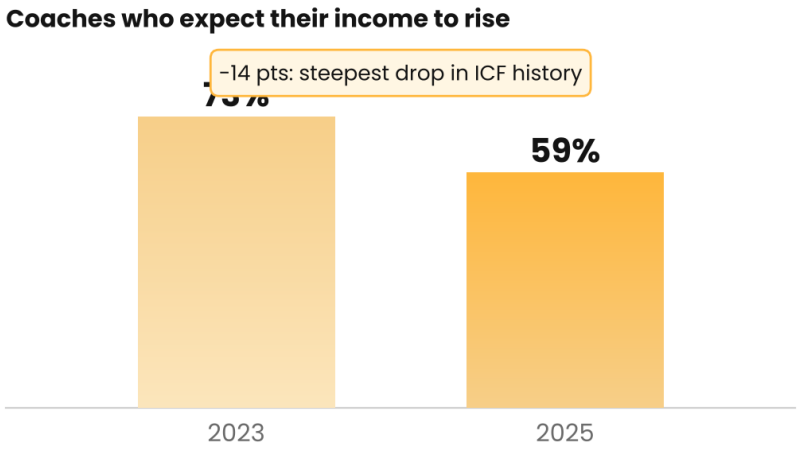
+60%
client acquisition cost over six years (Profi)

53%
of coaches earned under $30k in 2023 (ICF)

59%
expect income growth in 2025, down from 73% (ICF)

WHY IT HURTS

- Marketing effort is spent on tactics that do not compound.
- Every new client is expensive, so thin margins block reinvestment.
- Founders fall back on discounting, which damages positioning.



Source: ICF Global Coaching Studies 2023 and 2025, as analysed by The Coaching Tools Company.

SOLUTIONS FOR PROBLEM 01

Winning clients costs more, and gets harder every year

A

Run a proof-led content engine on one or two owned channels

Pick LinkedIn and YouTube (or Instagram) and commit to a fixed weekly rhythm instead of posting when inspired.

- Weekly minimum: one awareness clip, one educational video, one trust piece (case study or client story).
- Every piece ends with one call to action, never three.
- Review monthly: which topics produced conversations, then double down.

Track: conversations started per 10 posts; booked calls per month

B

Turn one long recording into a month of content

Record a podcast, webinar or teaching session once, then cut it into clips, quotes, carousels and newsletter issues.

- Pull 8 to 12 short clips per long recording, each with a stand-alone hook.
- Reuse the transcript for blog posts and email, so one idea works across five formats.
- Cost per piece falls while reach per idea rises.

Track: content pieces per hour of recording; cost per published piece

C

Build a single-path lead magnet

Give prospects one valuable asset and one obvious next step, so interest converts instead of leaking.

- Offer a diagnostic, checklist or short video training tied to your signature outcome.
- Strip form fields to name and email, and link every post to the same page.
- Follow with a three-email sequence that points to a booking link.

Track: landing-page conversion; email-to-call rate

HOW TO SEQUENCE THESE

Week 1: start with Solution A. First move: Weekly minimum: one awareness clip, one educational video, one trust piece (case study or client story). Week 3: add Solution B (turn one long recording into a month of content). Month 2: add Solution C (build a single-path lead magnet). Success signal: conversations started per 10 posts; booked calls per month.

02 Oversupply and a trust gap in the market

The profession keeps growing while buyers grow more sceptical of who to believe.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

ICF counted 122,974 coaches in 2025, 15% more than in 2023 and 54% more than in 2019. More coaches means more noise. Commentators describe a credibility problem: certificates do not prove business results, and sceptical buyers now ask for measurable outcomes. Coaches who cannot show proof look identical to everyone else.

122,974
coaches worldwide in 2025 (ICF)

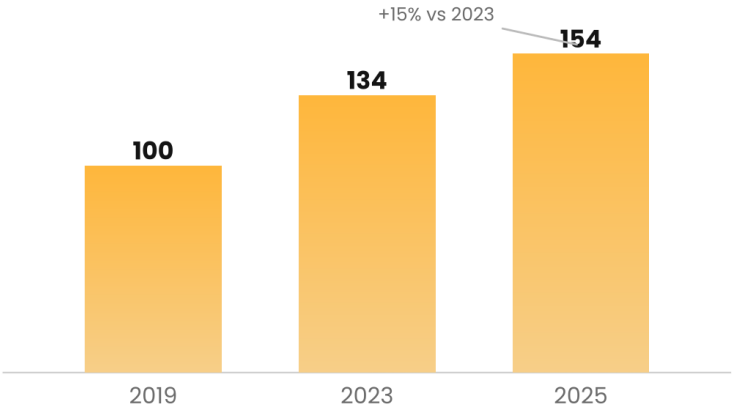
+54%
growth in practitioners since 2019

$5.34B
global coaching revenue (ICF 2025)

WHY IT HURTS

- Prospects cannot tell credible coaches from confident ones.
- Price pressure rises when differentiation is weak.
- Sales cycles lengthen because buyers need more reassurance.

Practitioner count index (2019 = 100)



Derived from ICF Global Coaching Study 2025: 122,974 coaches, +15% vs 2023, +54% vs 2019.

SOLUTIONS FOR PROBLEM 02

Oversupply and a trust gap in the market

A

Publish a case-study video library

Replace claims with evidence: starting point, what changed, measured result, in the client's own words.

- Use a fixed structure: baseline, intervention, outcome, what the client would tell a peer.
- Record 60 to 90 second cut-downs for social and a 4 to 6 minute full story for the site.
- Collect written consent and approval before publishing.

Track: share of calls where the prospect has already seen a case study

B

Show the work: teardown and walkthrough content

Let buyers watch your thinking, which is hard for a template or an AI summary to fake.

- Run live or recorded teardowns of a (consented, anonymised) business problem.
- Explain your method step by step, naming the framework you use.
- Invite questions in comments and answer them on camera.

Track: average watch time; replies and saves per teardown

C

Create a public scorecard of your track record

Transparency becomes a differentiator when the market is vague about results.

- Publish a quarterly page: clients served, typical timeline, what outcomes were measured and how.
- Add your credentials, methodology and who you do not serve.
- Link it from every bio and proposal.

Track: proposal-to-signature rate; inbound referrals mentioning the scorecard

HOW TO SEQUENCE THESE

Week 1: start with Solution A. First move: Use a fixed structure: baseline, intervention, outcome, what the client would tell a peer. Week 3: add Solution B (show the work: teardown and walkthrough content). Month 2: add Solution C (create a public scorecard of your track record). Success signal: share of calls where the prospect has already seen a case study.

03 Regulators are watching earnings claims

Income-style promises in coaching marketing carry growing legal exposure. This is information, not legal advice.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

In January 2025 the US FTC proposed expanding its Business Opportunity Rule to cover business coaching, which would require substantiation for earnings claims and let the agency seek refunds and penalties. The agency had earlier sent notices to more than 1,100 companies, including investment coaching firms, about deceptive earnings claims. Rule status can change, so confirm current requirements with a qualified lawyer in your market.

Jan 2025
FTC proposed rule covering business coaching

1,100+
firms sent FTC warning notices

Written
substantiation required for earnings claims under the proposal

WHY IT HURTS

- Testimonials that quote income or revenue can become liabilities.
- Refund disputes and platform ad rejections rise with aggressive claims.
- Reputation damage spreads to honest coaches in the same niche.

SOLUTIONS FOR PROBLEM 03

Regulators are watching earnings claims

A

Build a claims-substantiation file and compliant testimonial template

Treat every result you publish as something you must be able to prove.

- Keep a folder per claim: client consent, raw numbers, date range, how it was measured.
- Add a plain-language 'typical results' note beside results content.
- Review the file quarterly and retire stale claims.

Track: share of published claims with documented evidence (target 100%)

B

Tell outcome stories that avoid income promises

Show operational and behavioural change instead of what clients will earn.

- Focus on measurable inputs: leads generated, hires made, hours saved, margin improvement.
- Use before-and-after workflow content rather than revenue screenshots.
- Pair each story with the effort and timeline it took.

Track: testimonial videos without revenue promises per month

C

Publish a 'what to expect' explainer

Set honest expectations up front, which reduces refunds and builds long-term trust.

- Produce a short video and page: who it suits, time commitment, typical range of outcomes, risks.
- Send it before the sales call and again at onboarding.
- Mention it in follow-up emails when objections arise.

Track: refund requests; prospects citing the explainer on calls

HOW TO SEQUENCE THESE

Week 1: start with Solution A. First move: Keep a folder per claim: client consent, raw numbers, date range, how it was measured. Week 3: add Solution B (tell outcome stories that avoid income promises). Month 2: add Solution C (publish a 'what to expect' explainer). Success signal: share of published claims with documented evidence (target 100%).

04 Vague positioning and underpriced offers

Broad promises and hourly pricing make coaches interchangeable and cap their income.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Practitioner research repeatedly flags two linked mistakes: serving everyone with a vague promise, and selling time instead of outcomes. 'I help people reach their potential' gives a buyer nothing to compare or remember, and hourly pricing ties income to hours worked. Underpricing then leads coaches to think demand is the problem when positioning is.

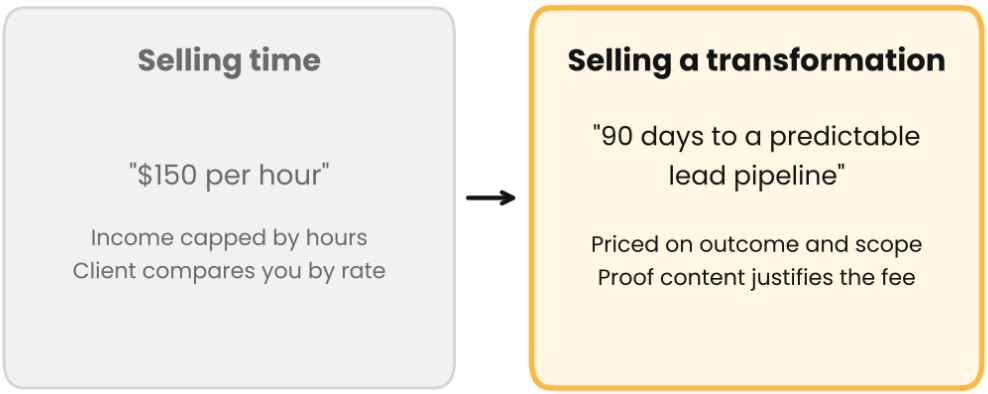
Most
coaches underprice, per Noomii's 2026 analysis

Hourly
pricing caps income and invites rate comparison

3 to 6 mo
outcome-based package length recommended by practitioners

WHY IT HURTS

- Content attracts the wrong audience or no audience.
- Prospects cannot repeat what you do, so they cannot refer you.
- Low prices attract low-commitment clients, who churn faster.



SOLUTIONS FOR PROBLEM 04

Vague positioning and underpriced offers

A

Run a 'for you / not for you' positioning series

Clarity repels the wrong buyer and magnetises the right one.

- Post a short series: three signs you are a fit, three signs you are not.
- Name your niche, stage and outcome in one sentence and use it everywhere.
- Name one signature framework so people can remember and repeat it.

Track: share of inbound leads that match your ideal client

B

Explain the offer with a short video sales letter

Package outcomes rather than hours, then show the logic on video.

- Structure: problem, cost of waiting, your method, proof, offer, next step.
- Keep it to 3 to 7 minutes and place it on the booking page.
- Re-cut a 60 second version for ads and outreach.

Track: booking-page conversion; average package value

C

Publish value math content

Justify premium pricing by showing what the problem costs and what the outcome is worth.

- Create a simple calculator or worksheet viewers can fill in.
- Walk through one worked example on video.
- Use the numbers on sales calls to anchor investment, not hourly rates.

Track: close rate at higher price points

HOW TO SEQUENCE THESE

Week 1: start with Solution A. First move: Post a short series: three signs you are a fit, three signs you are not. Week 3: add Solution B (explain the offer with a short video sales letter). Month 2: add Solution C (publish value math content). Success signal: share of inbound leads that match your ideal client.

05 Feast-or-famine revenue and referral dependence

Many practices live on word of mouth, which spikes and drops without warning.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Referrals can carry a coach to the first six figures, but practitioners warn that the flow is unpredictable and impossible to schedule. Revenue swings then push coaches into reactive marketing: a burst of posting after a quiet month, silence while clients are booked. The pipeline never compounds.

$100–200k
typical referral-built ceiling, per practitioner guides

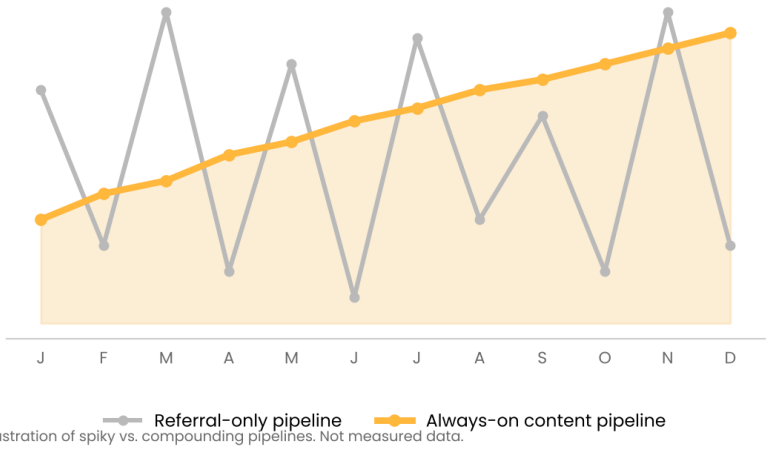
0
control over referral timing

Monthly
pipeline review cadence recommended

WHY IT HURTS

- Cash flow is hard to forecast, which delays hiring and tooling decisions.
- Marketing stops when delivery gets busy, which creates the next dry spell.
- Stress and discounting rise during slow months.

New-lead flow by month (illustrative)



Conceptual illustration of spiky vs. compounding pipelines. Not measured data.

SOLUTIONS FOR PROBLEM 05

Feast-or-famine revenue and referral dependence

A

Install an always-on cadence with a monthly pipeline review

Make content a standing operating process, not a reaction to a slow month.

- Set a minimum weekly output you can sustain during your busiest delivery weeks.
- Hold a 30 minute monthly review: content, conversations, calls, closes.
- Adjust topics based on conversations created, not likes.

Track: weeks with content published; qualified leads per month

B

Build evergreen nurture assets that work while you are booked out

Let content you made once keep selling for months.

- Create a welcome email sequence, a best-of video playlist and a starter guide.
- Add a newsletter with one idea and one story each week.
- Link all of it to a single next-step page.

Track: list growth; email-driven calls per month

C

Add a recurring-revenue content product

Smooth income with a lower-ticket product that sits beside 1:1 work.

- Options: cohort program, membership with monthly live Q&A, or a mini-course library.
- Use your best-performing free content to prove demand first.
- Feed graduates into your high-touch offer.

Track: monthly recurring revenue; upgrade rate to 1:1

HOW TO SEQUENCE THESE

Week 1: start with Solution A. First move: Set a minimum weekly output you can sustain during your busiest delivery weeks. Week 3: add Solution B (build evergreen nurture assets that work while you are booked out). Month 2: add Solution C (add a recurring-revenue content product). Success signal: weeks with content published; qualified leads per month.

06 Plenty of content, no conversion path

Coaches publish consistently yet still get no enquiries, because content is treated as the goal.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Several sources describe the same pattern: coaches post regularly, collect likes, and never ask the viewer to do anything. People rarely hire from a single post. They hire after a relationship forms across content, conversation and follow-up. Without that path, free content just educates prospects into self-serving.

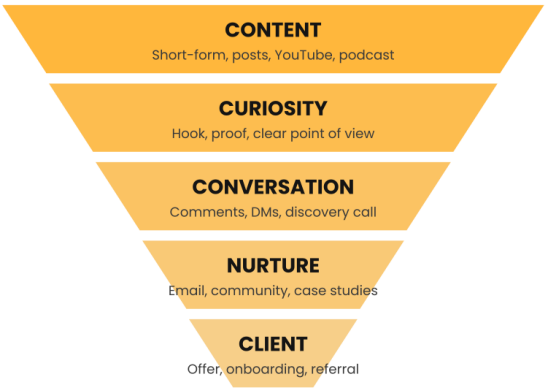
5 stages
content, curiosity, conversation, nurture, client

1 CTA
per piece converts better than several

Many
coaches do not know their funnel numbers

WHY IT HURTS

- Growing audiences do not turn into booked calls.
- Giving away expertise without a next step trains people to take but not buy.
- Effort feels wasted, which feeds burnout.



Funnel stages adapted from Wylo's 2026 coaching pipeline model.

SOLUTIONS FOR PROBLEM 06

Plenty of content, no conversion path

A

Map every content piece to a funnel stage and one action

Decide up front what the viewer should do next, then design the piece to earn that action.

- Tag each planned post: awareness, education, trust or decision.
- Give each tag one standard call to action (follow, comment, download, book).
- Review monthly which stage is under-served.

Track: percent of posts with a defined next step

B

Start conversations, not just views

Use comment keywords and DM prompts to move interest into one-to-one dialogue.

- Invite a keyword comment in exchange for a resource.
- Reply personally within a day using a short, human script.
- Offer a discovery call only after you understand the situation.

Track: DM conversations per week; conversation-to-call rate

C

Tighten the booking path with a short video on the page

Cut every unnecessary click between interest and calendar.

- Fix broken links and remove unnecessary form fields.
- Add a 60 to 90 second video explaining who the call is for and what happens on it.
- Use one calendar link everywhere.

Track: visit-to-booking rate

HOW TO SEQUENCE THESE

Week 1: start with Solution A. First move: Tag each planned post: awareness, education, trust or decision. Week 3: add Solution B (start conversations, not just views). Month 2: add Solution C (tighten the booking path with a short video on the page). Success signal: percent of posts with a defined next step.

07 AI is reshaping expectations, and the trust questions come with it

Clients and coaches both adopt AI faster than norms for disclosure and privacy are forming.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

ICF's 2025 study found 47% of coaches already use digital coaching platforms, and its 2026 Futures report puts technology and trust at the centre of the profession's next decade. A fitness-coaching survey found 91% of coaches use AI, though many are unsure how clients feel. Research suggests AI performs well for transactional and performance coaching but is far from replacing developmental, high-trust work. The pressure is on mid-tier, templated coaching.

47%
of coaches use digital coaching platforms (ICF 2025)

91%
of fitness coaches use AI (FitBudd, adjacent niche)

Trust
ICF 2026 report centres transparency and standards

WHY IT HURTS

- Low-cost AI tools compress prices for generic advice.
- Clients worry about data privacy and who they are really talking to.
- Coaches who hide AI use risk damage to trust when it surfaces.

SOLUTIONS FOR PROBLEM 07

AI is reshaping expectations, and the trust questions come with it

A

Lead with human-first content

Make the human parts of your work visible: voice, judgement, lived experience.

- Publish unscripted live sessions, Q&As and reaction videos.
- Tell stories from real engagements (consented) that show judgement under uncertainty.
- State clearly what you do that automation cannot.

Track: share of content featuring you on camera; reply sentiment

B

Use AI in the back office and publish an AI-use charter

Keep productivity gains and make your policy part of your brand.

- Use AI for research, outlines, transcripts and repurposing, but not to impersonate your advice.
- Write a one-page note: what tools you use, what data is stored, where you decide.
- Explain it on onboarding and on your site.

Track: hours saved per week; client questions answered by the charter

C

Build a content moat from original data

Own insight others cannot scrape: your clients' patterns, benchmarks and frameworks.

- Run a short annual survey of your niche and publish the findings.
- Anonymise and aggregate client patterns into named frameworks.
- Turn each finding into a video, post and one-page report.

Track: citations or shares of your research; inbound requests referencing it

HOW TO SEQUENCE THESE

Week 1: start with Solution A. First move: Publish unscripted live sessions, Q&As and reaction videos. Week 3: add Solution B (use ai in the back office and publish an ai-use charter). Month 2: add Solution C (build a content moat from original data). Success signal: share of content featuring you on camera; reply sentiment.

08 Organic reach is shrinking and written content is losing trust

Algorithms favour native, authentic formats, and buyers are wary of AI-written text.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

LinkedIn's company-page organic reach fell roughly 60 to 66% between 2024 and 2026, while its algorithm now rewards authentic engagement, native formats and dwell time. At the same time, AI-generated text has made B2B buyers more sceptical of written content. Video, by contrast, is trusted: most B2B buyers watch it during purchase decisions and many say they trust it more than text.

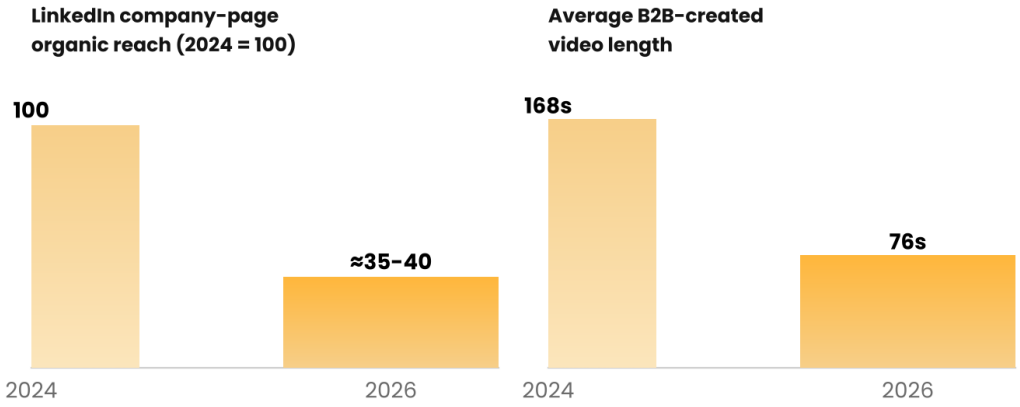
-60 to 66%
LinkedIn page organic reach, 2024 to 2026

70%
of B2B buyers watch video when buying

81%
trust video more than written content

WHY IT HURTS

- Following a text-first playbook yields shrinking returns.
- Company-page posting underperforms profile-led content.
- Dependence on one platform exposes revenue to algorithm changes.



Sources: Visla (reach fell roughly 60-66%, shown at midpoint-ish); VidPros (video length). Directional, not audited.

SOLUTIONS FOR PROBLEM 08

Organic reach is shrinking and written content is losing trust

A

Move to native short-form video from your personal profile

Shoot vertical-first, 30 to 90 seconds, with a clear hook and a single idea.

- Start with one awareness clip, one educational video and one trust piece per week.
- Add captions, tight pacing and a visible takeaway in the first three seconds.
- Repost the same cut to YouTube Shorts, Reels and TikTok.

Track: three-second hold rate; completion rate; profile visits

B

Create long-form 'trust assets' that rank and get cited

Long videos and podcasts work as searchable proof and feed AI answer engines.

- Publish one longer piece a month on YouTube with clear titles and chapters.
- Post full transcripts and summaries on your website.
- Use long-form for lead nurturing, since short clips capture attention and long videos convert.

Track: search-driven views; long-form to booked-call attribution

C

Own your audience

Move followers to an email list or community you control.

- Offer a recurring benefit worth subscribing for, not a one-off PDF.
- Reference your newsletter in every bio and end card.
- Review growth by source each month.

Track: email list growth rate; percent of leads from owned channels

HOW TO SEQUENCE THESE

Week 1: start with Solution A. First move: Start with one awareness clip, one educational video and one trust piece per week. Week 3: add Solution B (create long-form 'trust assets' that rank and get cited). Month 2: add Solution C (own your audience). Success signal: three-second hold rate; completion rate; profile visits.

09 Leaky discovery calls: no-shows and weak sales conversations

Scheduling, no-shows and admin remain core operational headaches, and many coaches do not track the numbers.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

ICF-based industry summaries keep listing no-shows, scheduling and admin among coaches' top operational challenges. A booked call carries expected value even when free, so every no-show has a real cost. Coaches who treat the call as a casual chat rather than a structured process also lose deals that content already warmed up.

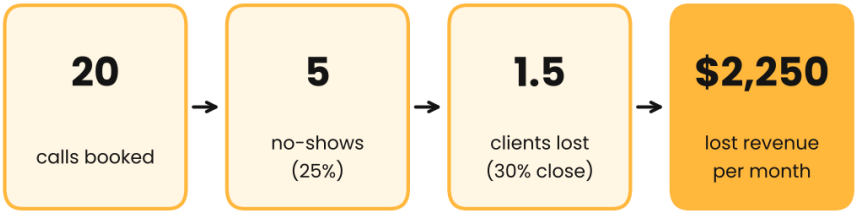
25%
no-show rate in the Coachway worked example

$2,250
lost monthly revenue in that example

3 numbers
booking, show and close rate to track

WHY IT HURTS

- Calendar time is wasted on people who never arrive.
- Warm leads go cold between booking and the call.
- Without numbers, you cannot tell whether content, calls or price is the weak link.



Worked example (Coachway): 25% no-show rate, 30% close rate, $1,500 per client.

SOLUTIONS FOR PROBLEM 09

Leaky discovery calls: no-shows and weak sales conversations

A

Send a pre-call content sequence

Make booked prospects feel prepared and committed before the call.

- Deliver a welcome video, a short case study and a 'what to prepare' note within an hour of booking.
- Add a reminder 24 hours before with a one-line reason to attend.
- Offer easy rescheduling to reduce silent no-shows.

Track: show-up rate

B

Build an objection-handling clip library

Answer the ten most common doubts in 30 to 60 second videos you can send in DMs and follow-ups.

- List objections from your last 20 calls: price, time, trust, fit.
- Record one clear answer per objection, using real examples.
- Send the right clip after the call or in a nurture email.

Track: close rate; time from call to decision

C

Track content-to-call attribution

Use simple tracking to see which topics lead to calls and which lead to clients.

- Add a source field to the booking form and UTM tags to links.
- Review booking, show and close rates monthly.
- Invest more in the topics that convert, not just those that get views.

Track: calls per content hour; revenue per content source

HOW TO SEQUENCE THESE

Week 1: start with Solution A. First move: Deliver a welcome video, a short case study and a 'what to prepare' note within an hour of booking. Week 3: add Solution B (build an objection-handling clip library). Month 2: add Solution C (track content-to-call attribution). Success signal: show-up rate.

10 Retention, accountability and churn

Keeping clients engaged between sessions drives lifetime value, yet most energy goes to acquiring new ones.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Coaching is a retention business: average client lifespan equals one divided by monthly churn, so small improvements compound. Studies in the adjacent health-coaching and personal-training niche report annual churn of 30 to 40%, with much of it driven by clients drifting away rather than dissatisfaction. Accountability between sessions is a repeated pain point for coaches.

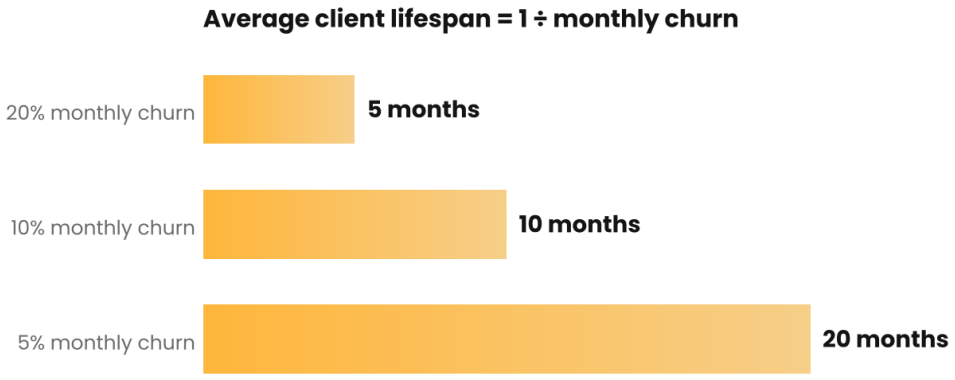
30-40%
annual churn in health coaching (adjacent niche)

5% to 10%
monthly churn halves client lifespan

25-95%
profit lift from 5% better retention (Bain, cited)

WHY IT HURTS

- Every lost client must be replaced at full acquisition cost.
- Revenue per client stays low because relationships end early.
- Fewer happy long-term clients means fewer referrals and case studies.



Formula and 5%/10% examples from Coachway; 20% case derived with the same formula.

SOLUTIONS FOR PROBLEM 10

Retention, accountability and churn

A

Create onboarding and progress content

Show clients the path and celebrate milestones so momentum is visible.

- Record a 5 minute onboarding video explaining the roadmap and what success looks like at 30, 60 and 90 days.
- Send a milestone recap after each phase.
- End each month with a short progress summary.

Track: 90-day retention; client goal achievement rate

B

Add between-session micro-content

Keep clients engaged with light, regular touchpoints rather than only the main session.

- Send a weekly two-minute video prompt or reflection question.
- Provide templates and checklists clients can use right away.
- Flag clients who stop engaging and reach out early.

Track: between-session engagement; early-warning save rate

C

Turn client wins into a referral loop

Public, consented success stories reinforce the client and attract new prospects.

- Ask for a short testimonial at each milestone.
- Feature wins in your community or newsletter.
- Invite a referral at the moment of peak satisfaction.

Track: referrals per active client; average tenure

HOW TO SEQUENCE THESE

Week 1: start with Solution A. First move: Record a 5 minute onboarding video explaining the roadmap and what success looks like at 30, 60 and 90 days. Week 3: add Solution B (add between-session micro-content). Month 2: add Solution C (turn client wins into a referral loop). Success signal: 90-day retention; client goal achievement rate.

11 Burnout and time poverty

Solo coaches juggle delivery, marketing and admin, and content creation often loses.

WHAT IS HAPPENING

Analysis of ICF 2025 data suggests well over 80% of coaches now offer services beyond coaching, such as consulting and training. Fitness coaches describe burnout from juggling a day job, content and a business, and trainers often leave because of burnout, unstable income and long hours. Peer-reviewed burnout research is mostly about sports coaches, so business-coach-specific data is thin; treat this as directional.

80%+
offer services beyond coaching (analysis of ICF 2025)

1 day
monthly recording day can batch 20+ pieces

48 hrs
typical first-draft turnaround at editing agencies

WHY IT HURTS

- Marketing stalls whenever delivery gets busy.
- Constant context switching reduces quality in both areas.
- Isolation and stress build when no one shares the load.

SOLUTIONS FOR PROBLEM 11

Burnout and time poverty

A

Batch your content in one monthly recording day

Replace daily improvisation with a planned production block.

- Choose 12 to 20 topics from client questions and plan hooks in advance.
- Record in one or two sessions with the same set-up and outfit changes.
- Queue posts for the next four weeks.

Track: hours per week on content; publish consistency

B

Delegate editing and design to a repeatable system

Hand off post-production using templates and clear style rules so your time goes to coaching.

- Write a one-page brief: style references, caption look, hook rules, brand colours.
- Hire or contract an editor or agency with a defined turnaround and revision process.
- Review in batches instead of per video.

Track: founder hours saved; turnaround time

C

Repurpose what you already create

Use sessions, webinars and podcasts as raw material so you never start from a blank page.

- With consent, record group calls and webinars.
- Pull teachable moments into clips and quotes.
- Keep a swipe file of client questions as a topic bank.

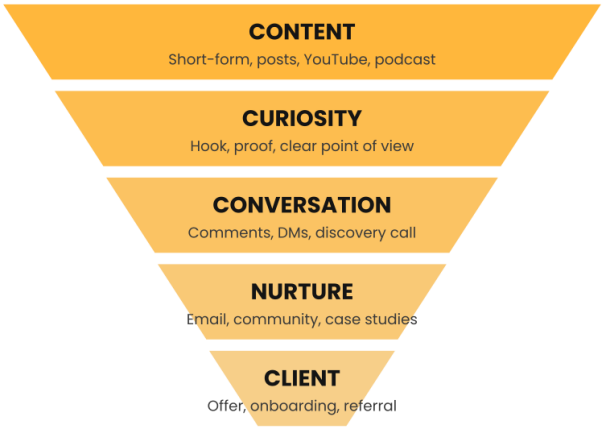
Track: share of content sourced from existing recordings

HOW TO SEQUENCE THESE

Week 1: start with Solution A. First move: Choose 12 to 20 topics from client questions and plan hooks in advance. Week 3: add Solution B (delegate editing and design to a repeatable system). Month 2: add Solution C (repurpose what you already create). Success signal: hours per week on content; publish consistency.

The content system that answers all eleven

Individual fixes work best inside one system. The model below combines the common threads: each piece of content has a job, every path ends in a conversation, and results are measured monthly.



Funnel stages adapted from Wylo's 2026 coaching pipeline model.



Mapping based on LinkedIn Creative Labs B2B video findings (via Bold Content).

Where video earns its place

Video is not the only answer, but the data shows it carries trust better than text in a market flooded with generic and AI-written copy. It is also expensive in founder time, which is why Problem 11 matters: the most successful approach is usually a lean production system, not more effort.

Why video carries the trust load



Sources: Wyzowl 2026; Levitate Media 2026; compiled by VidPros. Vendor-compiled surveys.

KEY TAKEAWAY

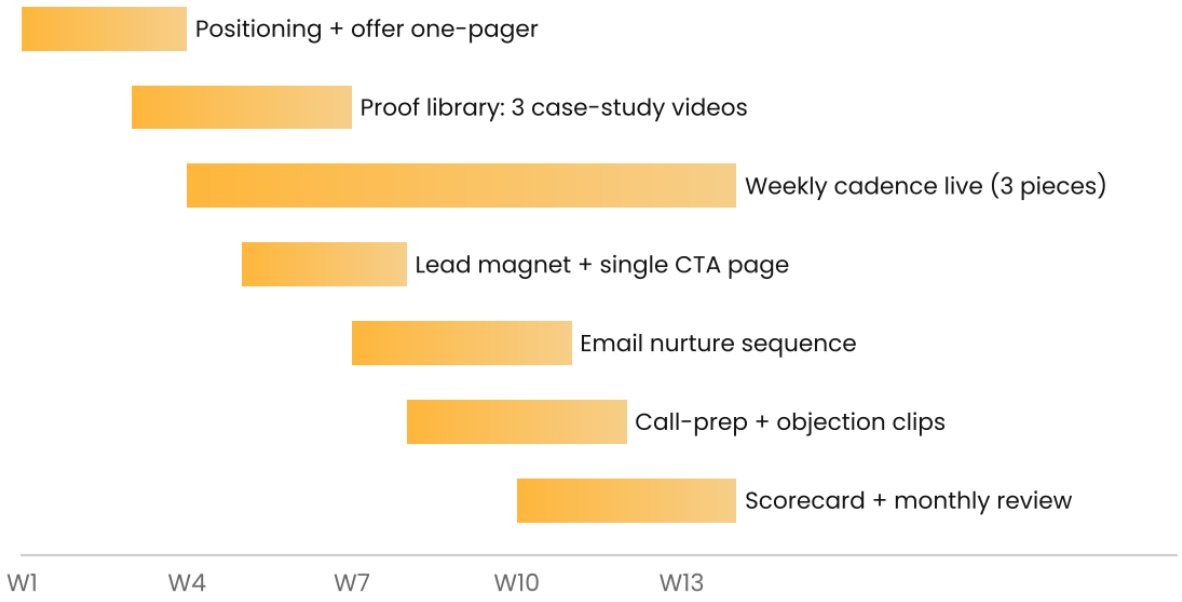
Short-form captures attention and long-form converts. Use short clips for reach and repeat exposure, and long videos, case studies and a video sales letter for the decision stage.

Suggested weekly cadence

Day	Output	Funnel stage	Call to action
Mon	Short clip: one sharp insight	Awareness	Follow or comment keyword
Wed	Educational video (3 to 6 min) or carousel	Trust	Download or reply
Fri	Client story or case-study cut	Decision	Book a call
Weekly	Newsletter: one idea, one story	Nurture	Reply or book

90-day rollout and scorecard

90-day rollout plan



Monthly scorecard

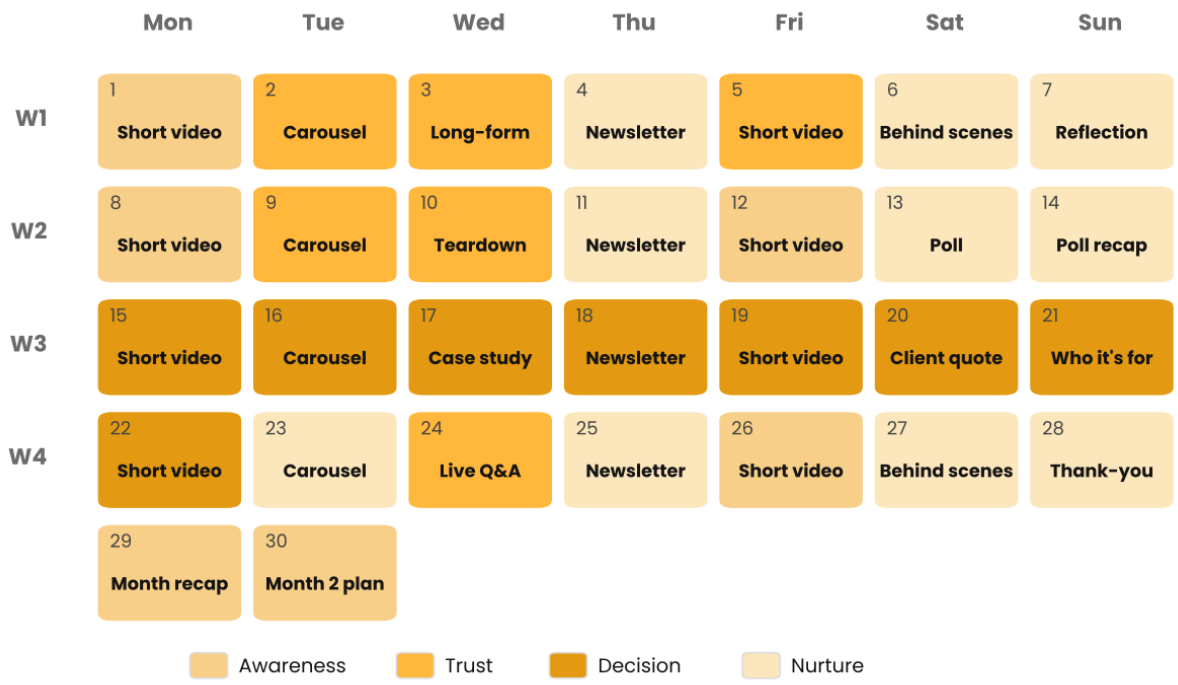
Metric	What it tells you	Review question
Conversations started	Content is creating real interest	Which topics triggered replies and DMs?
Booking rate	The page and offer are clear	Where do visitors drop off?
Show-up rate	Pre-call content is working	Did prepared prospects attend more often?
Close rate	Proof and positioning are strong	Which objections remain unanswered?
Retention / tenure	Delivery and engagement are healthy	Who is slipping before they cancel?
Founder hours on content	The system is sustainable	What can be batched or delegated?

30-Day Demo Content Plan

A day-by-day example you can copy: what to post on each of the next 30 days, with the exact topic, the opening hook, what to show or say, and the call to action. It is written for a demo coach, so swap in your own niche and stories while keeping the structure.

Demo coach	A business coach for founder-led service businesses (agencies and consultancies) who want a predictable flow of new clients.
Offer	90-day 'Predictable Pipeline' programme, priced by outcome and scope rather than hours.
Channels	LinkedIn (primary), plus YouTube for long-form, Instagram Reels and Shorts for repurposed clips, and a weekly email newsletter.
Rhythm	One post every day for 30 days. Mon to Fri carry the main pieces: 2 short videos, 1 carousel, 1 long-form or live, 1 newsletter. Weekends are light: a behind-the-scenes photo, poll or reflection. Start on any Monday.
Production	Record all videos for the coming week in one 2 to 3 hour session on Sunday afternoon, then send them to your editor. Weekend posts need no filming.
Daily habit	15 minutes for conversations: reply to every comment, comment on 5 posts from ideal clients, answer DMs, and log each new conversation.
Problems it targets	Acquisition (1), trust (2), positioning (4), funnel (6), reach (8), call leakage (9), time (11).

The 30 days at a glance



KEY TAKEAWAY

Week 1 builds credibility, Week 2 teaches your method, Week 3 converts with proof and a clear offer, and Week 4 nurtures, answers objections and reviews the numbers. Days 29 and 30 close the month and set up month 2.

W1 Week 1: Position and prove

Say clearly who you help, show why you are credible, and set up the path that turns attention into calls.

Week goal: 7 posts live, lead magnet and booking page ready, 15+ real conversations started.

SET UP FIRST

Before Day 1: create one lead magnet (a 10-point pipeline checklist), a booking page with a 60 to 90 second welcome video, and a tracking sheet (source, call booked, showed, closed).

Day	Format	Exact topic and opening hook	What to show or say	Call to action
1 Mon	Short video (45 s)	**3 signs you are not my client, and 1 sign you are** *"If you want overnight growth, skip this video."*	Talk to camera with 3 text overlays. End with who you ARE for, in one sentence.	Comment FIT
2 Tue	Carousel (7 slides)	**The 5-stage pipeline most coaches skip** *"Posting more will not fix an empty calendar. This will."*	One slide per stage: content, curiosity, conversation, nurture, client. Add one example per stage.	Save and share
3 Wed	Long-form video (6 min)	**Why good coaches still have empty calendars** *"Here is the gap I see again and again in coaching businesses."*	Screen-share a simple funnel sketch. Walk through one anonymised example of a leak.	Download the pipeline checklist
4 Thu	Newsletter #1	**What I got wrong about posting every day** *"[Your story] For months I posted daily and booked almost nothing."*	3-sentence story, the lesson, one fix the reader can use today. Under 300 words.	Reply with your biggest bottleneck
5 Fri	Short video (45 s)	**A client story in 45 seconds: before, one change, after** *"[Client type] came to me with an empty calendar. One change fixed it."*	Before, the one change, measured after. Use process results, not income claims.	Comment STORY
6 Sat	Behind the scenes (photo or story)	**How I plan my content week in 20 minutes** *"My whole content week fits on one page. Here it is."*	Photo of your planner or calendar plus 3 bullet points in the caption.	Ask: what does your week look like?
7 Sun	Text post	**The one number I am tracking this week** *"This week I am measuring one thing: conversations started."*	Explain why likes do not pay bills and how you will log conversations.	Share your number

W2 Week 2: Teach your method

Let buyers watch how you think. Name your framework and make your point of view easy to repeat.

Week goal: 7 posts live, first 40 email subscribers, 8+ discovery conversations.

SET UP FIRST

Before Day 8: set up a 3-email welcome sequence on the lead magnet (welcome, best resource, invitation to book).

Day	Format	Exact topic and opening hook	What to show or say	Call to action
8 Mon	Short video (45 s)	**The one metric to check every Monday** *"Stop checking likes. Check this instead."*	Define 'conversations started', show your tracking sheet, say how to log it in 2 minutes.	Follow for the weekly metric
9 Tue	Carousel (7 slides)	**Hourly pricing vs outcome pricing** *"Charging by the hour is why your income is capped."*	Slides: why hourly caps you, what outcome pricing is, an example package, how to start.	Comment PRICE for the worksheet
10 Wed	Teardown video (8 min)	**Live teardown: fixing a vague 'I help people reach their potential' bio** *"Watch me fix this bio in 8 minutes."*	Use a consented or anonymised bio. Rewrite in 4 steps: niche, outcome, method, proof.	Send me your bio to review
11 Thu	Newsletter #2	**The 3-Lane Pipeline: attract, convert, retain** *"Steady client flow comes from three lanes, not one."*	Name your framework. One example per lane. Ask readers to pick their weakest lane.	Reply with your weakest lane
12 Fri	Short video (45 s)	**You do not need a huge following to get clients** *"You do not need 50,000 followers. You need 50 right people."*	Explain a small, well-targeted audience plus real conversations. One example.	Share with a coach friend
13 Sat	Poll	**What is your biggest client-acquisition bottleneck?** *"One question. Four options. Honest answers only."*	Options: visibility, trust, sales calls, follow-up. This poll feeds your Week 4 Live Q&A.	Vote and comment
14 Sun	Text post	**3 things I learned from your poll answers** *"You told me something I did not expect."*	Summarise the results, pick one surprise, and promise a video on the top answer.	Follow for next week

W3 Week 3: Prove it and make the offer

This is the conversion week: case studies, what to expect, and a clear invitation to talk.

Week goal: 7 posts live, 6+ booked discovery calls, case-study video added to the booking page.

SET UP FIRST

Before Day 15: film the case-study interview (30 minutes with a consenting client) and write the pre-call sequence (welcome video, short case study, what to prepare).

Day	Format	Exact topic and opening hook	What to show or say	Call to action
15 Mon	Short video (45 s)	**A client result told in process metrics** *"Here is what changed in 90 days. No revenue numbers, just what we measured."*	Share leads per week, calls booked, hours saved. Use real figures and get consent.	Book a call
16 Tue	Carousel (7 slides)	**What to expect in 90 days** *"Here is the honest 90-day timeline, including what it asks of you."*	Month 1 foundation, month 2 consistency, month 3 conversion. Add weekly effort and who it is not for.	Comment CALL
17 Wed	Case-study video (5 min)	**Case study: from a silent profile to booked calls** *"Here is exactly what we changed, step by step."*	Baseline, what was in the way, three changes, measured outcome, what the client would tell a peer. Add a typical-results note.	Book a call
18 Thu	Newsletter #3	**The full case study and how the programme works** *"Last week I shared a client story. Here is the full version."*	Written case study, then the offer in three sentences. One link only.	Book a call
19 Fri	Short video (45 s)	**Objection #1: 'I do not have time for content'** *"'I do not have time' usually means 'I do not have a system'."*	Show your 3-hour weekly content system: plan, batch record, send to editor.	Reply TIME for the plan
20 Sat	Client quote (image post)	**What a client said about the process** *"I did not expect this to be the part they would mention."*	Quote card with the client's words about the process (consented, no income claims) plus 2 lines of context.	DM me if you want the same
21 Sun	Text post	**Who this programme is for, and who should wait** *"I turn down some founders. Here is who."*	List 3 good-fit signs and 3 'come back later' signs. Honest filtering builds trust.	Comment FIT or book a call

W4 Week 4: Nurture, answer objections, review

Keep warm leads moving, handle doubts on camera, and close the loop with measured results.

Week goal: 7 posts live, show-up rate above 80%, a clear view of which topics create calls.

SET UP FIRST

Before Day 22: announce the Live Q&A date on Day 20 to 21 and collect questions from the Week 2 poll and your comments.

Day	Format	Exact topic and opening hook	What to show or say	Call to action
22 Mon	Short video (45 s)	**Objection #2: 'It is too expensive'** *"Expensive compared to what? Let us do the maths."*	Compare the monthly cost of an empty calendar with the programme fee. No guarantees.	Book a call
23 Tue	Carousel (7 slides)	**My pre-call checklist (sent to every booked prospect)** *"Show up prepared and the call gets twice as useful."*	Slides: welcome video, what to prepare, 3 questions to think about, what happens next.	Save it
24 Wed	Live Q&A (30 min)	**Ask me anything about getting clients** *"Bring your hardest question about getting clients."*	Answer questions from the poll and comments. Record it. You will cut clips from this next.	Submit a question
25 Thu	Newsletter #4	**What I would tell a coach starting today, and the 3 numbers I track** *"Four weeks of posting taught me this."*	Three lessons, the three numbers (conversations, calls, show-ups), and an invitation to talk.	Reply or book a call
26 Fri	Short video (45 s)	**Best question from the Live Q&A** *"Someone asked: how do I start if I have no audience?"*	Cut the best answer from Day 24 into a 45 second clip with captions.	Follow for more
27 Sat	Behind the scenes (screenshot)	**My content dashboard: the 3 numbers I track** *"No vanity metrics here. Just these three."*	Screenshot of your tracking sheet with sensitive names hidden.	Comment SHEET for the template
28 Sun	Text post	**Thank you, and what is coming in month 2** *"Four weeks ago I started this experiment. Thank you."*	Short thank-you, one lesson, and ask which topic people want next.	Tell me your topic

29 Days 29 and 30: Review and reset

Close the month with an honest recap, then lock in the plan for month 2.

Goal: use your own numbers to pick what to repeat, change or drop.

SET UP FIRST
Review before posting: sort your 30 posts by conversations started. Keep the top 3 topics, rework the middle, drop the bottom.

Day	Format	Exact topic and opening hook	What to show or say	Call to action
29 Mon	Short video (45 s)	**30 days of consistent posting: what worked and what did not** *"I posted for 30 days straight. Here is the honest result."*	Share your own numbers (posts, conversations, calls) and one thing you would change.	Follow for month 2
30 Tue	Short video or text post	**Month 2: what I am doubling down on** *"These 3 topics started the most conversations."*	Name the top 3 topics and the one format that worked best. Preview next month.	Comment which topic you want next

Ready-to-use templates

Copy these, then replace the brackets with your own details.

Short-video script (45 seconds)	**0 to 3 s, hook:** '[Who it is for]: if [painful situation], watch this.' **3 to 12 s, problem:** name the cost of the problem in one sentence. **12 to 35 s, insight:** one idea, one example, no jargon. **35 to 45 s, proof and CTA:** one result in process terms, then one action: 'Comment [WORD] and I will send it.'
Carousel structure (7 slides)	Slide 1: bold promise. Slide 2: the problem. Slides 3 to 6: one step each, with one example. Slide 7: recap and one call to action.
Case-study outline (5 min)	1. Who the client is and the baseline (30 s). 2. What was getting in the way (45 s). 3. The three changes we made (90 s). 4. Outcome in measured terms and timeline (60 s). 5. What they would tell a peer (45 s). 6. Who it is and is not for, and the next step (30 s). Add consent and a typical-results line.
DM follow-up (3 messages)	**1:** 'Thanks for commenting on [topic]. What is the biggest thing stopping you from [outcome] right now?' **2 (after their reply):** 'That is common. Here is a 3-minute video on how to fix it: [link].' **3 (two days later):** 'If it helps to talk it through, here is my calendar: [link]. No pressure.'
Newsletter template	Subject: one clear idea. Body: a 3-sentence story, the lesson, one actionable step, one question to reply to, one link. Keep it under 300 words.

Day-30 review and example targets

Use these as starting targets and adjust to your own baseline. They are planning examples, not industry benchmarks.

Metric	Example month-1 target	If you miss it
Posts published	30 posts, including 4 newsletters	Drop weekends to optional and protect the Sunday recording session.
Conversations started	60 to 100 real two-way conversations	Check hooks and calls to action; ask more direct questions.
Email subscribers added	40 to 100 from the lead magnet	Make the lead magnet more specific to one problem.
Discovery calls booked	6 to 12	Look at the booking page, the video on it and the single link.
Show-up rate	80% or higher	Send the pre-call sequence earlier and add a 24-hour reminder.
Founder hours per week on content	5 hours or fewer	Batch more, delegate editing, reuse long recordings.

Month-end review questions

- Which three posts started the most conversations, and what did they have in common?
- Which posts got views but no conversations? Cut or rework the hook and call to action.
- Where did booked prospects first see you, and which proof did they mention on the call?
- Which objection came up most? Make that clip next month's opener.
- What took the most of your time, and can it be batched or delegated?

KEY TAKEAWAY

The plan works through consistency and measurement, not volume. If the month goes badly, change one variable (hook, offer or call to action) and run the month again. Results vary by niche, offer and execution, and nothing here is a guarantee.

Master matrix: problems and solutions

#	Problem	Solution A	Solution B	Solution C
01	Winning clients costs more, and gets harder every year	Run a proof-led content engine on one or two owned channels	Turn one long recording into a month of content	Build a single-path lead magnet
02	Oversupply and a trust gap in the market	Publish a case-study video library	Show the work: teardown and walkthrough content	Create a public scorecard of your track record
03	Regulators are watching earnings claims	Build a claims-substantiation file and compliant testimonial template	Tell outcome stories that avoid income promises	Publish a 'what to expect' explainer
04	Vague positioning and underpriced offers	Run a 'for you / not for you' positioning series	Explain the offer with a short video sales letter	Publish value math content
05	Feast-or-famine revenue and referral dependence	Install an always-on cadence with a monthly pipeline review	Build evergreen nurture assets that work while you are booked out	Add a recurring-revenue content product
06	Plenty of content, no conversion path	Map every content piece to a funnel stage and one action	Start conversations, not just views	Tighten the booking path with a short video on the page
07	AI is reshaping expectations, and the trust questions come with it	Lead with human-first content	Use AI in the back office and publish an AI-use charter	Build a content moat from original data
08	Organic reach is shrinking and written content is losing trust	Move to native short-form video from your personal profile	Create long-form 'trust assets' that rank and get cited	Own your audience
09	Leaky discovery calls: no-shows and weak sales conversations	Send a pre-call content sequence	Build an objection-handling clip library	Track content-to-call attribution
10	Retention, accountability and churn	Create onboarding and progress content	Add between-session micro-content	Turn client wins into a referral loop
11	Burnout and time poverty	Batch your content in one monthly recording day	Delegate editing and design to a repeatable system	Repurpose what you already create

Sources and notes

Research conducted in October 2026 using public web sources. Where a figure comes from a vendor, blog or compiled summary rather than a primary study, it is flagged in the text and should be treated as directional.

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- Frontiers in Psychology (2025) and related reviews on coach burnout (largely sports-coaching populations)

IMPORTANT

Charts marked illustrative or editorial are conceptual and not measured data. This report is general information for business planning, not legal, tax or financial advice. Results from any marketing approach vary by niche, offer and execution.